GO-BAG CHECKLIST

One bag per person, packed and ready to grab if you have to leave home in a hurry, with an inventory to keep it current.

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GUIDE / VERIFY: General preparedness information, not a substitute for professional advice, local emergency-management instructions or manufacturer directions. Needs differ by household and location. **Verify important information with current official sources before relying on it.**

A go-bag is for the first **3 days** away from home: the drive to a relative's house, a shelter, or a hotel. Keep it light enough to carry, and keep it where you can reach it on your way out the door. Children can carry a small bag of their own.

1. PACK LIST

WATER AND FOOD

- ☐ Water: 3 liters or more, and a refillable bottle.
- ☐ 3 days of food that needs no cooking: bars, nut butter, dried fruit, crackers.
- ☐ Water filter or purification tablets. *(TR-02)*

HEALTH

- ☐ Prescription medicines (a week or more) and a written list of them.
- ☐ Small first-aid kit.
- ☐ Glasses or contacts; hearing-aid batteries.
- ☐ Hand sanitizer, toilet paper, toothbrush, feminine supplies.
- ☐ N95 masks.

CLOTHING AND SHELTER

- ☐ A change of clothes and underwear; extra socks.
- ☐ Rain jacket and a warm layer, whatever the season.
- ☐ Sturdy shoes, if you're not wearing them.
- ☐ Emergency blanket (foil) and a light blanket.

LIGHT, POWER AND INFORMATION

- ☐ Flashlight or headlamp and spare batteries.
- ☐ Phone charging cable and a charged power bank.
- ☐ Small battery or crank radio.
- ☐ Paper map of your area with routes marked. *(TR-04)*

DOCUMENTS AND MONEY

- ☐ Copies of IDs, insurance cards and key documents in a waterproof bag. *(DC-05)*
- ☐ Emergency Contact Sheet. *(DC-01)*
- ☐ Cash in small bills.
- ☐ Spare house and car keys.

TOOLS

- ☐ Whistle.
- ☐ Multi-tool or knife.
- ☐ Duct tape (a few feet wrapped around a pencil or bottle).
- ☐ Lighter and matches in a waterproof container.
- ☐ Plastic bags, zip ties, notepad and pencil.

PETS

- ☐ Food, water, bowl, leash or carrier, medicines, records and a photo of your pet.

WEIGHT: for most adults a loaded bag should be well under 25 lb. Pick it up and walk around the block with it. If that's hard, take something out.

2. WHEN YOU LEAVE

1. Leave when officials tell you to, or sooner if you feel unsafe. Don't wait for conditions to get worse.
4. Lock the house. Leave a note saying where you're going, if it's safe to do so.

2. Take the go-bags, phones, medicines, pets and the car kit.
3. If there's time and it's safe, follow official instructions about turning off utilities.
5. Take the routes officials name. Shortcuts may be blocked.
6. Tell your out-of-area contact where you are going. *(DC-01)*

3. INVENTORY AND ROTATION

Check the bag every 6 months. Swap clothes for the season, replace food and water before they expire, and charge the power bank.

BAG OWNER	ITEM	EXPIRES / REPLACE BY	CHECKED	NOTES

SOURCES / FURTHER REFERENCE

1. FEMA: Ready.gov: Build a Kit; Evacuation. `ready.gov/kit  ready.gov/evacuation`
2. American Red Cross: Survival Kit Supplies. `redcross.org`

IMPORTANT: Follow evacuation orders from local officials. This list reflects the sources above as of November 2026.